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grip each of the side ropes in the pair independently and with the same grip force. Any surface of a mechanical clamping device that pilots or other personnel may handle shall be suitable to be grasped by bare hands. The use of cable ties, u -clamps or worm driven clips as a means of securing steps is prohibited.
5 Combination arrangements
5.1 The length of the accommodation ladder shall be sufficient to ensure that its angle of slope does not exceed 45°. In ships with large draught ranges, several pilot ladder hanging positions shall be provided, resulting in lesser angles of slope. The accommodation ladder shall be at least 600 mm in width. The accommodation ladder hoisting and lowering mechanism shall include protection that ensures the mechanism cannot be inadvertently operated during the transfer of pilots and other personnel.
5.2 Intermediate platforms, if fitted, shall be self -levelling. Treads and steps of the
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5.2 Intermediate platforms, if fitted, shall be self -levelling. Treads and steps of the accommodation ladder shall be so designed that an adequate and safe anti -skid foothold is provided at the operative angles.
5.3 The accommodation ladder and platform shall be equipped on both sides with stanchions and rigid handrails, but if hand ropes are used, they shall be tight and properly

secured. The vertical space between the handrail or hand rope and the stringers of the ladder shall be securely fenced.
5.4 Accommodation ladders, together with any suspension arrangements or attachments fitted and intended for use in accordance with these performance standards, shall meet the requirements for the means of embarkation on and disembarkation from ships as required by regulation II-1/3-9.
5.5 In the case of a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder with a
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regulation II-1/3-9.
5.5 In the case of a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder with a trapdoor in the lower platform, the lower platform shall:
.1 have an aperture with dimensions not less than 750 mm x 750 mm which is open to the ship's hull on the inboard side and which is designed to ensure that the horizontal distance between the pilot ladder and adjacent edges of the aperture is between 0.1 and 0.2 m;
.2 be designed and constructed to:
.1 allow the pilot ladder and manropes to pass through the aperture without obstruction or distortion;
.2 ensure the pilot ladder lies flat against the ship's side;
.3 ensure that structural members shall not interfere with or lay against the pilot ladders; and

.4 ensure the highest step of the pilot ladder is at least 2 m above the lower platform and remain compliant with part B;
.3 not be provided with fixtures other than the frame referred to in
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lower platform and remain compliant with part B;
.3 not be provided with fixtures other than the frame referred to in
paragraph 5.5.7, which allows a pilot ladder to be suspended from the lower platform of the accommodation ladder;
.4 have a trapdoor which opens upwards and which is secured flat on the embarkation platform or against a stanchion either at the aft end or outboard side of the platform, and in any case not obstructing the access to the ship;
.5 be provided with sufficient round handholds with a diameter of no less than 28 mm and not more than 32 mm to allow safe mounting or dismounting of the pilot ladder. The structure of the platform itself shall not be relied upon to provide handholds;
.6 be provided with sufficient handholds with a height of not less than 1.2 m above the platform; and
.7 where a structural frame is used to comply with paragraph 5.5.2, the following shall apply:
.1 the accommodation ladder platform, frame, pilot ladder connection
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shall apply:
.1 the accommodation ladder platform, frame, pilot ladder connection
points, accommodation ladder winch, running gear, pad eyes of manropes and locking arrangements shall be designed to withstand vertical forces of at least 48 kN;
.2 the highest step of the pilot ladder is at least 2 m above the platform and is secured to pad eyes on the inboard side of the frame so that it rests firmly against the side of the ship; and

.3 manropes are secured directly to additional pad eyes 2 m above the platform on the inboard side of the frame.
5.6 On all ships to which section 5 applies, a two -tone visual mark, the upper half being white and the lower half being red, not less than 4 m in height and 0.5 m in width shall be provided in the midship half -length of the ship in the vicinity of the pilot b oarding position to
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provided in the midship half -length of the ship in the vicinity of the pilot b oarding position to
indicate to the user whether or not a combination arrangement is to be rigged. The dividing line between the upper and the lower halves of the pilot line shall be 9 m below the point of access.

6 Securing arrangements
6.1 All strong points, shackles and securing ropes provided or used in accordance with part A or part B shall have a breaking strength of not less than 48 kN. Securing ropes shall be tagged or otherwise permanently marked in the same way as provided in paragraph 11.3 and those used to aid in rigging the pilot ladder, shall be at least 3 m in length. The securing arrangements shall be positioned not less than 915 mm, or, if not possible, the maximum distance permitted by the width of the deck, from the edge of the deck, except for the case of a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder. Strong points and shackles shall
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a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder. Strong points and shackles shall have breaking strength or equivalent safe working load limits clearly and permanently marked. Documentation of the conformance of the strong points, shackles and securing ropes shall be maintained on board and available for inspection purposes.
6.2 Permanent or removable means of bowsing a pilot ladder or embarkation platform to the ship's hull shall not be used to support the weight of the boarding arrangement or pilot and shall not be used for any other purpose than to secure the arrangement against the ship's side. Removable means of bowsing a pilot ladder or embarkation platform to the ship's side shall be able to be applied and removed by a single person and shall have a holding force of not less than 4 kN when used for the purpose of securin g the lower platform of an accommodation ladder or 3 kN when used for securing the pilot ladder or manropes.5F

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ladder or 3 kN when used for securing the pilot ladder or manropes.5F
6.3 There shall be a means of securing a pilot ladder at intermediate lengths which shall be capable of securing the pilot ladder to strong points described in paragraph 6.1 by gripping each set of side ropes of the pilot ladder. The means of securing, shall have a breaking strength of not less than 48 kN and be designed to prevent any slippage of the side ropes under the conditions of the ladder and step attachment strength test and unrolling tests described in a standard acceptable to the Organization. When type approving means of securing a pilot ladder at intermediate lengths in accordance with Part F, these tests shall be modified to reflect the attachment of the pilot ladder using a means of securing the pilot ladder other than using its own attachments.
7 Ships' side openings, doors and platforms
7.1 Ships' side doors used for the transfer of pilots or other personnel shall not open
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7 Ships' side openings, doors and platforms
7.1 Ships' side doors used for the transfer of pilots or other personnel shall not open outwards unless located below the freeboard deck. The side opening shall enable a safe, convenient and unobstructed passage large enough for the transfer of pilots and other personnel, with a minimum clearance of 2,200 mm in height and 915 mm in width.
7.2 Ships' side openings without a boarding platform shall be provided with strong points which are on the lowest deck of the opening and inboard of the ship's side opening. Strong points shall also be provided on the deck head and inboard of the ship 's side opening if it is intended to rig manropes in the manner provided for in paragraph 15.1.1.3.

7.3 In any event, boarding platforms deployed from ships' side openings and outboard of the ship shall not be provided where the distance from the platform to the surface of the water

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the ship shall not be provided where the distance from the platform to the surface of the water
in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim associated with the normal operation of the ship

is less than 5 m. Platforms shall be mechanically attached to the ship and be marked with safe working load limits. Certification of successful testing shall be maintained on board and available for inspection.

7.4 The boarding platform shall extend outboard from the ship's side for a minimum distance of 750 mm, with a longitudinal length of a minimum of 750 mm. The platform shall be securely guarded by handrails.

8 Access to ship's deck

Means shall be provided to ensure safe, convenient and unobstructed passage for pilots and other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the head of the pilot

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other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the head of the pilot
ladder, or of any accommodation ladder, and the ship's deck; such access shall be gained directly by a clean and unobstructed platform securely guarded by handrails. Where such passage is by means of:

.1 a gateway in the rails or bulwark, adequate handholds with a diameter of not less than 32 mm and not more than 36 mm shall be provided at the point of embarking on or disembarking from the ship on each side which shall be not less than 0.7 m and not more than 0.8 m apart in clear width. Each handhold shall be rigidly secured and locked to the ship's structure at or near its base and also to the ship at a higher point, and shall extend not less than 1.2 m above the deck to which it is fitted. Stanchions or handrails of the gateway shall not be attached to the bulwark ladder to prevent the bulwark ladder from overturning

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